



How to use this book

1. Choose who helps as the Guide.
2. Make a hero in five easy steps.
3. Use Strength, Int, Agility, Wis, or Luck when a roll is exciting.
4. Keep the story warm: heroes can be muddy, surprised, or silly, but never shamed.



Table feel: point at the picture, ask what the hero notices, then roll only when it is exciting.

For Adventurers 5–7: read choices aloud, let adventurers point to pictures, and use small bonuses (+2, +1, +0) instead of lots of maths.

What you need

- One six-sided die.
- A pencil, character sheet, and three little counters.
- A grown-up or older sibling Guide.
- A promise to listen and take turns.

What players say

- “I help.”
- “I try the brave thing.”
- “Can I talk to it?”
- “I look closer.”
- “Can my friend help?”

First table promise

Every player gets a turn to say one idea before the dice decide anything.





THE EASY DICE RULE

When the answer is obvious, no roll is needed. When everyone leans forward and wonders what might happen, roll one six-sided die and add the hero's matching stat bonus.

Total	Result	Say it like this
1–3	Wobble	It goes wrong in a funny, safe, or messy way.
4–5	Yes, but...	It works, and there is a tiny cost or choice.
6+	Bright success	It works well, and the hero feels proud.

No failure spiral: a wobble changes the scene; it does not stop the adventure.

The five classic stats

- **Strength** — lifting, climbing, holding, pushing, protecting.
- **Int** — puzzles, facts, plans, reading runes, remembering.
- **Agility** — sneaking, dodging, catching, balancing, jumping.
- **Wis** — feelings, animals, nature, noticing, sensible choices.
- **Luck** — charms, surprises, odd magic, last-chance moments.

When not to roll

- The action is safe and obvious.
- An adventurer is only describing how they look or feel.
- The group already found a kind solution.
- A roll would slow a warm moment.

Helping rule

If another hero clearly helps, add +1 or let the adventurer roll again and choose the better die.



STAT CREATION: CLASSIC FIVE STATS

1. Strength

Lifting, climbing, holding, pushing, protecting.

2. Int

Puzzles, facts, plans, reading runes, remembering.

3. Agility

Sneaking, dodging, catching, balancing, jumping.

4. Wis

Feelings, animals, nature, noticing, sensible choices.

5. Luck

Charms, surprises, odd magic, last-chance moments.

Assign bonuses: choose one best stat at **+2**, two good stats at **+1**, and two normal stats at **+0**.

Worked example: Rowan the Beast Friend has Wis +2, Agility +1, Luck +1, Strength +0, Int +0.



HP, MP, AND RESTING

Heart Points (HP)

HP shows how much bumping, slipping, startling, and tiring a hero can handle before they need a rest. Heroes are never described as badly hurt; low HP means muddy, shaken, sleepy, or overwhelmed.

Level	Hero HP	Hero MP
1	10 + Strength	6 + Wis or Luck
2+	+2 HP each level	+1 MP each level

Magic Points (MP)

MP fuels adventure spells. Cantrips cost 0 MP. Most spells cost 1 MP; bigger story spells cost 2 MP if the Guide allows them.

Resting

- **Snack rest:** after a quiet snack, regain 2 HP and 1 MP.
- **Safe camp:** after a full rest, regain all HP and MP.
- **At 0 HP:** the hero sits out one tense moment, then returns with 1 HP when a friend helps.

Gentle rule: HP is pacing, not punishment. Adventurers should feel worried for the hero, not scared for themselves.



LEVELING AND FEATS

Level	What changes	What to say
1	Choose kindred, job, stats, cantrip, gear.	"This is who I am at the start."
2	+2 HP, +1 MP, learn one new spell or tool trick.	"I learned from the road."
3	Improve one +0 stat to +1.	"I practised something hard."
4	+2 HP, +1 MP, choose one feat.	"I have a special talent."
5	Improve one +1 stat to +2, learn one spell.	"I am growing into a hero."
8	Choose another feat.	"My legend gets bigger."

Feats every 4 levels

Stout Heart

+3 HP. Once per session, stand back up with 1 HP after a friend cheers you.

Deep Spark

+2 MP. Your first adventure spell each session costs 0 MP.

Lucky Pocket

Once per session, spend a copper, button, or charm to reroll Luck.

Helpful Friend

When you help another hero, they gain +2 instead of +1.

Storm Runner

At level 4+, ignore one weather trouble per session if you describe a bold dash.

Oath Keeper

At level 4+, when you keep a promise despite danger, regain 1 MP.

Monster Friend

At level 8+, one creature you helped may return once as an ally.

Relic Bearer

At level 8+, carry one extra enchanted item without trouble.







KINDRED

GLENFOLK

Glenfolk are croft, cottage, castle, and market-lane adventurers with practical hearts. They know how to ask neighbours, find a dry path, and make ordinary things feel brave.

Culture

Glenfolk grow up where ordinary people meet fairy trouble: fishing piers, bakery lanes, crofts, castles, and wind-bent roads. Their families teach names, favours, and practical courage.

Known for

Good manners with common folk; practical plans; knowing who owns the key.

“I know someone who might help.”

Story gift

Once per adventure, remember a local clue or helpful person.

Look

- Tartan scarf, muddy boots, treasure pockets.
- A wooden badge, snack cloth, or tiny family charm.

Good at the table

- Ask an auntie, shepherd, baker, guard, or gardener for help.
- Know what a tool is called or where a path should go.
- Offer practical kindness: a snack, blanket, or fixed latch.

Home and people

A smoky cottage, market street, watch tower, or sheep path with a view of rain.

Best first stat

Int or Wis

First scene idea

A village gate is stuck and everyone has an idea.



KINDRED

THISTLE FAIRY

Thistle Fairies are small bright folk with manners, shimmer, and secret paths. They are excellent at noticing fairy marks that bigger people step over.

Culture

Thistle Fairies keep old courtesies: say thank you to doorways, bow to bees, and never laugh at a mushroom ring. They can be dramatic, but they hate lonely places.

Known for

Fairy etiquette, secret doors, tiny gossip, and lucky timing.

“I bow politely and look for the sparkle.”

Story gift

Once per scene, notice nearby fairy magic.

Look

- Petal cloak, star freckles, tiny crown.
- Boots that never quite touch the puddles.

Good at the table

- Ask flowers, moths, or beetles for tiny gossip.
- Spot a hidden ring of mushrooms or a polite fairy door.
- Remember an old rule of fairy manners.

Home and people

A flower hall, bell-stem tower, hollow thorn, or moonlit garden path.

Best first stat

Luck

First scene idea

A secret flower-door opens only after a polite greeting.



KINDRED

BROWNIE HELPER

Brownie Helpers are cozy fixers who tidy, mend, and improve small things. They turn a messy room, broken spoon, or squeaky hinge into a clue.

Culture

Brownie Helpers believe a home is a promise you can sweep, mend, stir, and share. They notice what changed in a room because they know how rooms should feel.

Known for

Mending, cleaning, small tools, and spotting what is out of place.

“I can fix the little thing first.”

Story gift

Repair or improve one tiny object each scene.

Look

- Apron, tool pouch, flour on nose.
- Buttons, string, thimble hat, or polished spoon.

Good at the table

- Fix a latch, mend a pouch, clean mud from a clue.
- Find the important thing hiding in a pile of mess.
- Make a worried home feel safe again.

Home and people

A warm kitchen, stable loft, hidden pantry, or workshop under the stairs.

Best first stat

Int

First scene idea

A kitchen clue is hidden under a very silly mess.



KINDRED

SELKIE-BORN

Selkie-Born heroes have gentle loch-hearts and moonlit dreams. They understand water, weather, and the soft feelings people hide under their coats.

Culture

Selkie-Born families tell stories beside dark water. They know that songs can be maps, tears can be messages, and coats can carry memories.

Known for

Listening, weather sense, comfort, swimming, and quiet courage.

"I listen to the loch before I answer."

Story gift

Understand water, weather, or a sad feeling.

Look

- Soft seal-cloak, shell button, sea-glass charm.
- Wet curls, quiet eyes, and pockets full of smooth stones.

Good at the table

- Hear what rain, waves, or a puddle is trying to say.
- Comfort a lonely creature without many words.
- Find a safe way across shallow water.

Home and people

A loch shore, fishing boat, moon pool, sea cave, or rain-soft village.

Best first stat

Wis

First scene idea

A sad loch-creature will only speak to someone gentle.



KINDRED

ROWAN-KIN

Rowan-Kin are forest adventurers with leaf crowns and careful listening. Old trees remember them, birds trust them, and red berries mark their promises.

Culture

Rowan-Kin learn that every path has a memory. They tie red threads for promises and leave crumbs for birds who carry news.

Known for

Nature signs, quiet movement, forest memory, and protective promises.

"I ask the old tree what it remembers."

Story gift

Ask a tree, bird, or breeze for one hint.

Look

- Red berries, green cloak, bark-pattern gloves.
- Leaf crown, acorn buttons, or a walking twig.

Good at the table

- Read bent grass, scratched bark, or a bird alarm.
- Ask an old tree who passed this way.
- Hide gently among leaves without frightening anyone.

Home and people

A rowan grove, mossy den, treehouse, old standing stone, or fern tunnel.

Best first stat

Wis or Agility

First scene idea

An old tree remembers the wrong name and needs patient listening.



KINDRED

HEATHER GIANTLING

Heather Giantlings are small for giants, huge for fairies, and very gentle. They are best when something heavy, high, or frightening needs a careful friend.

Culture

Heather Giantlings are taught that strength is for shelter. They remember hill songs, stone names, and how to make big footsteps soft.

Known for

Careful strength, carrying friends, big calm, and hill-country stories.

"I can be big and gentle at the same time."

Story gift

Lift, push, or carry one heavy thing safely.

Look

- Big knitted jumper, pebble buttons, warm laugh.
- Purple heather in hair and boots like little boats.

Good at the table

- Hold a door, carry a tired friend, or move a fallen branch.
- Stand calmly when a noise is big.
- Ask hills, stones, or goats about family stories.

Best first stat

Strength

Home and people

A hillside bothy, giant family cairn, sheep meadow, or cave with a warm fire.

First scene idea

A fallen branch blocks the path, but small animals live underneath.



KINDRED

CAIRNLING

Cairnlings are living little stone-folk awakened from old hill cairns. They have pebble shoulders, moss brows, and memories older than castles.

Culture

Cairnlings keep the oldest promises of Alba. They carve memory-knots into stones and believe every hill has a voice.

Known for

Stone memory, patience, endurance, and old border knowledge.

"I listen to the stone under my feet."

Story gift

Once per adventure, ask old stone what it has seen or endured.

Look

- Pebble plates, moss beard, carved rune cheeks.
- A hollow chest that softly echoes when danger is near.

Good at the table

- Stand firm against wind, fear, or pushing.
- Remember ancient roads, burials, borders, and broken oaths.
- Blend into rocks, cairns, walls, and ruins.

Best first stat

Strength or Wis

Home and people

A standing stone ring, mountain cairn, ruined tower, or sleeping giant road.

First scene idea

A border stone remembers the wrong king and blocks a road.



KINDRED

MOSSKIN

Mosskin are antlered green folk of bog, bark, fern, and lichen. Their hair grows tiny leaves, and their footsteps smell of rain.

Culture

Mosskin clans move with seasons and speak to roots before making camp. They dislike axes used without thanks.

Known for

Plant speech, bog lore, hiding, and patient healing.

“The moss knows who passed here.”

Story gift

Once per scene, make plants show a clue, path, or warning.

Look

- Small antlers, fern cloak, bark fingers, green-gold eyes.
- Mushrooms on the hat and a pouch of seeds.

Good at the table

- Ask moss which way feet travelled.
- Grow a tiny bridge, cushion, or hiding tuft.
- Know whether a forest is angry, hungry, or afraid.

Home and people

A bog island, oak hollow, fern den, or hidden green hall.

Best first stat

Wis

First scene idea

A bog path grows angry because someone cut living roots.



KINDRED

CORBIE-FOLK

Corbie-Folk are raven-winged omen-speakers with black feathers, bright eyes, and a fondness for shiny secrets.

Culture

Corbie-Folk are not bad omens; they are messengers. They carry news between clans, cairns, and battlefields.

Known for

Omens, messenger lore, aerial scouting, and shiny clues.

“I saw a sign in the black wings.”

Story gift

Once per adventure, see an omen: a safe warning, lucky sign, or clue in the sky.

Look

- Feather mantle, beak-like mask, black wing-cloak.
- Silver rings, bone charms, or a pouch of bright buttons.

Good at the table

- Fly or glide a short safe distance.
- Understand ravens, crows, battlefield flags, and old songs.
- Find shiny clues that others overlook.

Best first stat

Agility or Luck

Home and people

A cliff nest, ruined belfry, pine rookery, or wind tower.

First scene idea

Ravens circle a battlefield cairn with an omen nobody understands.



KINDRED

STAR-SPRITE

Star-Sprites are tiny blue-white folk fallen from cold northern lights. They glow when excited and hum when maps are wrong.

Culture

Star-Sprites tell time by constellations and trade dreams for safe shelter. They fear cages and love open skies.

Known for

Starlight, tiny size, prophecy marks, and wonder.

"I shine just enough to see the secret."

Story gift

Once per scene, glow starlight that reveals hidden ink, footprints, or fairy doors.

Look

- Tiny luminous body, comet hair, silver freckles.
- A lantern shell, star-pin, or moon-thread sash.

Good at the table

- Slip through tiny spaces without separating from the group.
- Read constellations, old prophecy marks, and moon doors.
- Light one dark corner without using fire.

Home and people

A crystal cave, observatory ruin, moon pool, or thistle lantern.

Best first stat

Luck

First scene idea

A moon door opens only for starlight and a brave question.



KINDRED

MYCELING

Mycelings are mushroom-and-root folk who remember places through underground threads. They are quiet, strange, and excellent at finding hidden connections.

Culture

Mycelings are patient archivists of the earth. They treat decay as a library and old logs as storybooks.

Known for

Connections, underground maps, spores, and quiet wisdom.

“Everything is connected underneath.”

Story gift

Once per adventure, ask the under-root network whether two places, people, or clues are connected.

Look

- Mushroom cap hood, root fingers, soft glowing spots.
- A satchel of spores, clay beads, and beetle-shell buttons.

Good at the table

- Sense tunnels, cellars, buried doors, and old roots.
- Share a whisper through a root or mushroom ring.
- Recognize poisons, potions, and strange spores.

Home and people

A mushroom circle, root archive, cellar grove, or damp fairy hall.

Best first stat

Int or Wis

First scene idea

The under-root network whispers that two mysteries share one source.





ADVENTURE JOB

THISTLE KNIGHT

Thistle Knights protect friends and stand bravely at the front. They are not rough or bossy; they make scary moments feel safer for everyone.

Training

Knights train with wooden shields, promise words, and the rule that strength must leave people safer than before.

“I stand tall so my friend can try.”

Gift

Once per scene, turn a scary moment into a brave one.

Class stat block

HP 12 + 2/level	MP 6 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +2	INT +0	AGI +1	WIS +1	LUK +0

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Shield Spark: make a tiny glowing shield mark that shows where protection is needed.

Class spells

- Shield Spark (0 MP): mark the safest square.
- Shield of Thistles (1 MP): hold back wind, rain, or branches.

Try this

- Hold a shield or walking stick like a promise.
- Stand between danger and a friend.
- Say a brave sentence out loud.

Starter kit

- Soft shield
- Promise ribbon
- Thistle badge



ADVENTURE JOB

LOCH SCOUT

Loch Scouts find paths, listen for clues, and spot hidden doors. They love maps, footprints, bird calls, and the first tiny sign that something changed.

Training

Scouts learn to stop first, look second, and step third. They are brave because they are careful.

“I look closely before we move.”

Gift

Ask the Guide one “what do I notice?” question.

Class stat block

HP 10 + 2/level	MP 6 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +0	INT +1	AGI +2	WIS +1	LUK +0

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Mist Mark: leave a harmless glowing footprint only friends can see.

Class spells

- Mist Mark (0 MP): leave friend-only glowing footprints.
- Mist Step (1 MP): slip past a watcher or trap.

Try this

- Follow tracks through reeds or heather.
- Read a map or remember a landmark.
- Balance across stepping stones.

Starter kit

- Chalk
- String map
- Tiny lantern



ADVENTURE JOB

SONG-SPARK BARD

Song-Spark Bards use music, jokes, and stories to lift everyone up. Their magic is cheer, rhythm, and the courage that comes from being heard.

Training

Bards collect funny endings, gentle jokes, and songs that remind scared folk they are not alone.

“I sing the brave bit for you.”

Gift

Give another hero +1 after a kind song, rhyme, joke, or cheer.

Class stat block

HP 10 + 2/level	MP 8 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +0	INT +1	AGI +0	WIS +2	LUK +1

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Courage Note: hum a note that gives one friend a smile and steady hands.

Class spells

- Courage Note (0 MP): steady a friend.
- Kind Whisper (0 MP): help someone say a feeling.
- Brave Chorus (1 MP): give two friends +1 on the same scene.

Try this

- Cheer a friend who feels unsure.
- Calm a crowd with a rhyme.
- Make a grumpy bridge laugh politely.

Starter kit

- Bell
- Ribbon drum
- Story cards



ADVENTURE JOB

HEARTH MAGE

Hearth Mages carry warm, safe magic: sparks, steam, tea, and tiny lights. Their spells help problems; they do not solve the whole story alone.

Training

Hearth Mages practise with kettles, kind words, and sparks no bigger than fireflies.

“A tiny warm spell might help.”

Gift

Create a small helpful magical effect.

Class stat block

HP 10 + 2/level	MP 8 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +0	INT +1	AGI +0	WIS +2	LUK +1

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Glow-Pebble: make a pebble or spoon shine like a candle.

Class spells

- Glow-Pebble (0 MP): candle-sized light.
- Tea-Steam (0 MP): warm or reveal breeze.
- Foxfire Path (1 MP): find the gentlest route.

Try this

- Light a path with a glow-pebble.
- Warm cold hands with tea-steam.
- Reveal a hidden breeze or fairy mark.

Starter kit

- Teacup
- Glow pebble
- Little spoon wand



ADVENTURE JOB

BEAST FRIEND

Beast Friends understand animals and earn trust with gentle patience. They notice tails, ears, paws, feathers, and feelings before they roll dice.

Training

Beast Friends learn posture, patience, and how to let a creature choose to come closer.

“I crouch down and speak gently.”

Gift

Ask a friendly creature for a small favor.

Class stat block

HP 10 + 2/level	MP 8 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +0	INT +0	AGI +1	WIS +2	LUK +1

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Gentle Scent: make your hand smell like oats, apples, rain, or safe grass.

Class spells

- Gentle Scent (0 MP): smell like oats, apples, or safe grass.
- Kind Whisper (0 MP): calm a creature.
- Foxfire Path (1 MP): find a nature route.

Try this

- Offer a snack without grabbing.
- Copy a small sound politely.
- Ask what the creature feels.

Starter kit

- Oat pouch
- Soft brush
- Kindness bell



ADVENTURE JOB

PUZZLE TINKER

Puzzle Tinkers build, open, balance, fold, and wonder how things work. They like ordinary bits: string, cups, buttons, chalk, and clever questions.

Training

Tinkers ask “what happens if?” and keep spare buttons because every mystery has a small moving part.

“What if this little thing fits here?”

Gift

Make a simple tool from ordinary bits.

Class stat block

HP 10 + 2/level	MP 7 + 1/level	ARM 0	LVL 1	
STR +0	INT +2	AGI +1	WIS +0	LUK +1

Class stat block shows a strong default build. Adventurers may still choose their own +2, +1, +1, +0, +0 spread.

Class cantrip

Button-Click: make one harmless latch, knot, or toy mechanism wiggle once.

Class spells

- Button-Click (0 MP): wiggle one latch, knot, or toy mechanism.
- Tiny Mend (1 MP): repair one small object.
- Rune Read (1 MP): ask one question about old writing.

Try this

- Fix a latch or squeaky hinge.
- Build a tiny bridge from safe pieces.
- Turn clues into a simple plan.

Starter kit

- String
- Chalk
- Button box

SKILLS AND CHECKS

What is a skill?

A skill is a thing an adventurer knows how to try. Skills do not add extra numbers. They tell the table which stat makes sense and what tools might help.

Skill	Usual stat	Example
Climb / Hold	Strength	Hold a rope while friends cross.
Riddle / Rune	Int	Read fairy marks on a gate.
Sneak / Dodge	Agility	Step around creaky roots.
Notice / Soothe	Wis	Calm a frightened creature.
Charm / Chance	Luck	Trust a lucky button at the last second.

How checks work

- Say what the adventurer tries.
- Pick the stat that matches the method, not the problem name.
- Add +1 if gear or a friend clearly helps.
- Roll d6 + stat bonus only if the answer is exciting.
- On a wobble, move the scene forward with a cost, noise, mess, or choice.

Trap example: A twig-bell trap can be Agility to step over it, Int to disarm it, Wis to notice it, Strength to hold a branch aside, or Luck to bump it in a harmless way.



COMBAT AND DANGER

Combat is a tense scene

Combat in Adventures in Alba is not about hurting enemies. It is about protecting friends, dodging trouble, tiring a creature out, breaking a spell, or helping something stop being scary.

1. The Guide describes danger and feeling.
2. Each adventurer says one action.
3. Roll only for exciting actions.
4. Reduce HP when someone is bumped, tired, scared, tangled, or splashed.
5. At 0 HP, a hero needs help; a creature stops fighting and can be soothed, tricked, or understood.

Combat actions

Action	Stat	On success
Protect a friend	Strength	Friend avoids 2 HP of trouble.
Dodge claws, roots, or falling stones	Agility	You avoid harm and move somewhere useful.
Spot the weak point in a spell	Int	Next hero gets +1.
Calm or distract	Wis	Creature loses 1 MP or changes feeling.
Use a charm	Luck	Turn a bad moment into a funny cost.

Damage guide: small bump 1 HP, scary hit or trap 2 HP, boss special 3 HP. Keep descriptions safe: muddy, tangled, dizzy, startled, sleepy.



TRAPS, OBSTACLES, AND GEAR

Traps are puzzles with a warning

Use traps as playful obstacles: bell strings, sleepy roots, sticky jam doors, rune locks, puddle mirrors, or a bridge that sneezes. Always give a clue before a trap matters.

Trap	Notice	Checks
Twig-bell alarm	Tiny bells in moss	Wis notice, Agility step, Int untie.
Sleepy root snare	Roots yawn quietly	Agility hop, Strength pull, Wis sing awake.
Moon-rune lock	Cold silver letters	Int read, Luck button, MP Rune Read.

Equipment matters

Gear	Helps with	Table effect
Rope	Climb, rescue, measure.	+1 when it clearly helps.
Lantern	Dark, mist, caves.	Reveals one clue before a roll.
Chalk	Maps and marks.	Prevents getting lost once.
Tiny toolkit	Locks and repairs.	Allows Int checks on devices.
Oat pouch	Animal trust.	+1 Wis with hungry creatures.

Gear question: “What do you pull from your pack, and how does it help the adventurer?”



EXAMPLE SCENARIO: ADVENTURER VIEW

The Bell-Root Path

You see: a path of soft moss, tiny silver bells tied to roots, and a sleeping fox curled beside a moon-rune door.

You feel: the place is quiet, like it is holding its breath.

Your choices

- Step carefully between the bells: Agility.
- Study how the bells are tied: Int.
- Whisper to the fox and ask what it knows: Wis.
- Hold the branch up for a friend: Strength.
- Tap your lucky button and choose the quietest root: Luck.

If things go wrong

- Wobble: one bell rings and the fox opens one eye.
- Yes, but: you pass, but your cloak snags a root.
- Bright success: you reach the moon-rune door and find a silver acorn key.

Adventurer tip: describe the idea first. The stat comes after everyone understands what your hero is doing.



EXAMPLE SCENARIO: ADVENTURER COMBAT

The Bramble Sneak jumps out

A red-capped bramble creature shakes thorns and hisses, “No one takes my shiny bell!” It looks more scared than mean.

Adventurer turns

- Knight: protect a friend with Strength.
- Scout: dodge through roots with Agility.
- Bard: sing a silly rhyme with Wis.
- Mage: spend 1 MP on Glow-Pebble to show the bell is not stolen.
- Tinker: use Int to spot the bramble knot holding its cap too tight.

How it ends

When the Bramble Sneak reaches 0 HP, it is not defeated forever. It is tangled, tired, and ready to listen. If the adventurers offer the bell back or promise a new shiny button, it becomes a grumpy guide.

Reward: the Bramble Sneak shows a shortcut under the thorn arch and gives one copper it thought was a magic moon.



SPILLS, GEAR, AND TREASURE



Rule: magic helps the story; it does not solve every problem alone.

Safe little spells

- **Glow-pebble:** make a small light.
- **Tea-steam:** warm cold hands or reveal a breeze.
- **Thistle-tickle:** distract a grumpy creature for a moment.
- **Kind whisper:** help someone say what they feel.
- **Button-bridge:** make a tiny bridge for one small creature.
- **Heather-hush:** quiet a noisy room for one careful question.

Spell limit

A spell can help one small problem. Big problems still need friends, ideas, and choices.

Starting gear

- A snack wrapped in cloth.
- One useful tool.
- One pretty charm.
- One thing your hero drew themselves.
- A spare ribbon, button, bell, shell, or smooth stone.
- A tiny notebook for clues or doodles.

Useful tools

Tool	Use
Lantern	See misty paths.
String	Tie, measure, or rescue.
Chalk	Mark a safe way back.
Wooden cup	Offer water, tea, or kindness.

Treasure prompts

Find	Story use
Silver button	Opens a promise gate.
Ribbon	Marks a safe path.
Bell	Calls one fairy friend.

Treasure is story-first: a shiny button can matter more than a bag of coins if it unlocks a promise.



SPELL LIST

Cantrips: always small, always safe

Spell	Roll	Cost	What it does
Glow-Pebble	Luck	0 MP	Make a pebble or charm shine like a candle.
Tea-Steam	Wis	0 MP	Warm cold hands or reveal a hidden breeze.
Button-Bridge	Int	0 MP	Make a tiny bridge for toys, fairies, or clues.
Heather-Hush	Wis	0 MP	Quiet one noisy room long enough for a careful question.
Thistle-Tickle	Luck	0 MP	Distract a grumpy creature for one moment.
Kind Whisper	Wis	0 MP	Help someone say what they feel.

Adventure spells

Spell	Roll	Cost	Use
Mist Step	Agility	1 MP	Slip past a watcher if a friend describes the mist.
Rune Read	Int	1 MP	Ask the Guide one question about old writing.
Lucky Button	Luck	1 MP	Turn one wobble into “yes, but” once per session.
Shield of Thistles	Strength	1 MP	Hold back wind, rain, or falling branches for a turn.
Foxfire Path	Wis	1 MP	Find the gentlest route through a confusing place.
Tiny Mend	Int	1 MP	Repair a small broken object so it can help the story.

Spell rule: spells solve one small problem. Big problems still need choices, friends, and consequences.



EQUIPMENT SHOP

Starter money: each hero starts with 1 silver (10 copper). Choose a few useful things before the first adventure. Save at least 1 copper for snacks, tolls, or lucky wishes.

Item	Cost	Use
Lantern	3 copper	See in mist, caves, and under bridges.
Rope	3 copper	Climb, tie, rescue, measure, or make a line.
Chalk	1 copper	Mark a safe path or draw a puzzle answer.
Snack bundle	1 copper	Share with a friend or hungry creature.
Wooden shield	4 copper	Helps Strength rolls to protect or hold steady.
Soft boots	4 copper	Helps Agility rolls to sneak or balance.
Tiny toolkit	5 copper	Helps Int rolls to mend, open, or build.
Oat pouch	2 copper	Helps Wis rolls with animals.
Lucky button	3 copper	Helps one Luck roll per adventure.
Warm cloak	3 copper	Stay cosy in rain, wind, or moonlit cold.
Bell	2 copper	Call a friend, mark a rhythm, or wake a sleepy path.
Blank notebook	2 copper	Draw maps, clues, promises, and creature friends.

Coin names

Coin	Value	Use
Copper	Basic coin	Snacks, chalk, rope, simple tools.
Silver	10 copper	Starter purse, good tools, inn beds.
Gold	10 silver	Rare rewards, mounts, special training.
Mythral	100 gold	Legendary fairy metal; a story treasure.

Starter kits

Kit	Cost	Contains
Knight kit	8 copper	Wooden shield, rope, snack bundle.
Scout kit	8 copper	Lantern, chalk, soft boots.
Mage kit	8 copper	Lucky button, notebook, bell, chalk.
Friend kit	8 copper	Oat pouch, warm cloak, snack bundle, bell.

MORE SPELL AND GEAR EXAMPLES

Class cantrips in play

Job	Cantrip scene
Thistle Knight	Shield Spark marks the safest place to stand.
Loch Scout	Mist Mark leaves friend-only glowing footprints.
Song-Spark Bard	Courage Note steadies a worried friend.
Hearth Mage	Glow-Pebble lights a cupboard, bridge, or cave.
Beast Friend	Gentle Scent makes a hand smell like oats or apples.
Puzzle Tinker	Button-Click wiggles one latch or knot.

Coin examples

Reward	Coins	Feels like
Helping a baker	3 copper	Snack money.
Returning a moon-bell	1 silver	A real thank-you.
Saving a village festival	1 gold	A rare reward.
Finding mythral	1 mythral	A legendary story treasure.

Shopping prompt: ask each player, “What do you buy, and how will it help someone?”



MAKING A HERO: QUICK CHECKLIST

1. Name your hero.
2. Pick a kindred.
3. Pick an adventure job.
4. Choose stats: one +2, two +1, two +0.
5. Pick one gear item and one charm.
6. Answer: “Who do I want to help?”

Worked example: Rowan Moonbutton is a Selkie-Born Beast Friend. Stats: Wis +2, Agility +1, Luck +1, Strength +0, Int +0. Gear: oat pouch. Charm: sea-glass button. Rowan wants to help nervous animals.

Grown-up tip: do not quiz an Adventurer on rules. Ask what they imagine, then translate that into Strength, Int, Agility, Wis, or Luck.

Common first purchases

Hero idea	Good buys
Protector	Shield, rope, snack bundle.
Explorer	Lantern, chalk, soft boots.
Mage	Lucky button, bell, notebook.
Animal friend	Oat pouch, warm cloak, snack.

End of session

Ask: “Who did we help?” “What should we draw?”
“What promise did we make?”

Track level

After a finished adventure, mark one story star. Four story stars usually means the hero gains a level.

If a player is stuck

Offer two choices: “Do you want to talk kindly, move quickly, or do the brave thing?”

If the group gets loud

Point to the picture, name one sound in the scene, then ask one adventurer what their hero notices.



MORE HERO OPTIONS

Backgrounds

Backgrounds give adventurers a first memory, a home tie, and one table reason to ask questions.

Background	You know	Starter thing
Croft Kid	Animals, weather, chores.	Oat pouch.
Castle Page	Heraldry, manners, maps.	Ribbon badge.
Loch Fisher	Knots, boats, quiet patience.	Fishing line.
Market Runner	Prices, gossip, shortcuts.	Coin purse.
Hill Dreamer	Stars, stories, odd signs.	Dream pebble.

Earned pets

Pets are not bought at character creation. They join after an adventure where the party helps, feeds, frees, or understands them.

Pet	Earn by	Helps with
Rowan mouse	return its stolen crumb-hoard.	Sneaking and tiny keys.
Cloud moth	guide it to safe starlight.	Finding soft light.
Thistle hedgehog	save it from a boot-trap.	Noticing danger.
Seal pup	bring its song back to the loch.	Water clues.

Background rule: once per session, if your background clearly helps, add +1 or ask the Guide for one extra clue. Pets use the companion rules on the next page.



EARNED MOUNTS AND PETS

Companion rule

Mounts and pets are story friends, not shopping items. Earn one by helping it, keeping a promise, or finishing a quest. A companion never replaces a hero; it opens one extra approach.

- One companion may actively help the party in a scene.
- If it clearly helps, add +1 or reveal one clue before a roll.
- If danger targets it, the Guide offers a rescue choice instead of punishment.
- A companion needs care: food, rest, kindness, and a job it enjoys.

Earned, not bought: coins can buy tack, feed, or shelter, but trust must be won in play.

Companions to earn

Companion	Earn by	Helps with
Highland pony	free it from a bog rope.	travel, carrying, courage.
Cairn goat	find its lost bell on a cliff.	climbing paths.
Fairy stag	protect its grove from tax-magic.	fast travel once per adventure.
Kelp-mane pony	return a moon-water charm.	safe loch crossings.
Rowan owl	solve an old-name riddle.	warnings and night clues.
Border warg	break the command collar.	tracking and brave defense.

Companion bond track

Bond	What it means	Unlock
1	Trusts the party.	+1 once per session.
2	Comes when called.	Can carry a message or small item.
3	Chooses the heroes.	May return dramatically once per campaign.



PLAYER CHOICES: MORE JOBS AND BACKGROUNDS

New jobs

- Cairn-Warden: protect oaths and stones.
- Storm-Singer: weather songs and brave speeches.
- Rune Tinker: locks, maps, clever gadgets.
- Goat Knight: mountain travel and comic bravery.
- Loch Herbalist: potions, cures, water lore.
- Crow Messenger: secrets, scouting, omens.

Backgrounds

- Raised by bridge-keepers.
- Found in a fairy ring.
- Apprentice to a kettle witch.
- Kin to a storm-clan poet.
- Grew up on a longship market.
- Escaped a Red Banner border fort.

Starting gift ideas

- Ask one bridge/road question.
- Know one old hill name.
- Carry one tiny healing tea.
- Understand one animal mood.
- Find one hidden door in mist.
- Turn a wobble into funny mud once.

Pet/mount hooks

- Find a lost cairn bell.
- Break a warg collar.
- Protect a fairy stag grove.
- Guide a cloud moth home.
- Share oats with a Highland pony.
- Solve a rowan owl riddle.



PROGRESSION BEYOND LEVEL 1

Level rewards

Level	Reward
2	+2 HP or +2 MP; learn one spell/card.
3	Choose a feat/gift.
4	Upgrade one companion bond or home base.
5	Earn a named mythral story relic.

Feat examples: Brave Helper, Quick Feet, Old Name Knower, Gentle Beast Voice, Red Wax Breaker, Storm-Song.

Campaign tracks

Track	How it grows
Companion bond	care, rescue, trust scenes.
Faction reputation	help clans/courts/towns.
Home base	add stable, library, kitchen, map room.
Spell upgrade	name, promise, ingredient.



MORE MAGIC: SCHOOLS AND RITUALS

Four gentle spell schools

Schools are story flavors, not homework. Use them to describe how magic looks, sounds, and asks for promises.

School	Feels like	Examples
Hearth	warmth, light, mending	Glow-Pebble, Tiny Mend
Loch	mist, water, memory	Mist Step, Moon Reflection
Thistle	protection, brambles, courage	Shield of Thistles, Prickle Path
Story	songs, names, promises	Courage Note, Name Echo

Rituals

A ritual is a slow spell that takes a scene, a promise, and three ingredients. It usually costs 2 MP from the group instead of one hero.

- Name what you want: light, bridge, truth, calm, memory.
- Offer three ingredients: coin, feather, song, button, water, ash, berry.
- Every adventurer says one helpful line.
- Roll Wis, Int, or Luck if the answer is exciting.

Ritual mishap: on a wobble, the ritual works but leaves a funny sign: purple hair, hiccuping bells, sleepy shoes, or talking moss.



Spell Upgrades

Level	Upgrade choice	Example
2	Longer light	Glow-Pebble lasts a whole scene.
3	Friend boost	A cantrip can help a nearby friend.
4	Feat spell trick	Choose one spell feat when you gain a feat.
5	Big ritual	Group rituals can affect a bridge, grove, or cottage.

Spell feat: Careful Magic

Once per session, when you spend MP, ignore the first harmless magical mess.

Spell feat: Shared Spark

Spend 1 extra MP so a friend also gets +1.

Spell feat: Bright Cantrip

Pick one cantrip. It can affect two tiny things instead of one.

Spell feat: Old Words

You may ask the Guide what one rune, rhyme, or fairy name means.

Spell feat: Potion Nose

You can identify a potion, poison, or enchantment ingredient by smell once per session.

Spell feat: Rune Stitcher

You may repair one damaged charm during a safe camp.



ADVANCED COMBAT OPTIONS

Armor and shields

Gear	Cost	Rule
Padded cloak	4 silver	Once per scene, reduce 1 HP of trouble.
Wooden shield	6 silver	Protect a friend at +1 if you can reach them.
Thistle charm	1 gold	Reduce one bramble/spell trouble by 1 HP.

Conditions

Condition	Means	Ends when
Tangled	You need help to move far.	Strength, Agility, or a friend helps.
Startled	Next roll is -1 unless soothed.	Friend says something kind.
Sleepy	You can act, but slowly.	Snack, song, or fresh air.
Glittered	Easy to spot.	Wash, cloak, or scene ends.
Poisoned	A venom causes a temporary condition.	Use the listed cure.
Cursed	A spell changes the scene rules.	Break the rune, oath, or item.

Boss phases: at half HP, a boss changes the scene: fog rolls in, bridge wakes, or the creature admits what it truly wants.

Battle complications

- Falling stones split the party into two zones.
- A banner gives enemies +1 until cut down.
- A poison cloud makes everyone seek clean water.
- A frightened monster grabs a map instead of a hero.





ENCHANTMENTS AND MAGIC ITEMS

Enchanting rule

- Choose a plain item: blade, cloak, ring, harp, lantern, boots, spoon, shield.
- Choose one enchantment word: Bright, Thorn, Loch, Cairn, Storm, Rowan, Moon, Ember.
- Pay the ingredient cost and make a promise about how the item will be used.
- Enchanted items add +1 only when the story clearly matches their word.

Limit: carry one active enchanted item per level. Mythral items count as two.

Enchantment spells

Spell	Cost	Effect
Wake Charm	1 MP	Ask a sleeping magic item what it wants.
Bind Brightness	2 MP + silver dust	Store one cantrip inside an item until next dawn.
Rune-Lock	2 MP	Seal a door, chest, or promise until the right word is spoken.
Unweave Curse	3 MP group ritual	Turn a harmful enchantment into a clue, mark, or choice.



MAGIC ITEM EXAMPLES

Cairn-Knuckle Ring

+1 Strength when holding, bracing, or remembering an oath. If used selfishly, it grows heavy.

Loch-Mirror Cloak

+1 Agility in mist or moonlight; on a wobble, your reflection gives advice too late.

Storm-Harp String

A bard can spend 1 MP to turn thunder, shouting, or battle-noise into a steady rhythm.

Rowan-Bark Shield

Once per scene, reduce 2 HP of trouble from thorns, arrows, or frightened beasts.

Star-Moth Lantern

Reveals hidden ink, invisible tracks, and fairy doors; moths follow it everywhere.

Mythral Seed Blade

A legendary story weapon. It cuts curses and brambles, not helpless foes. Worth 100 gold or one impossible promise.



POTIONS AND POISONS

Potions

Potion	Cost	Effect
Heatherheart Draught	2 silver	Regain 3 HP and ignore Startled once.
Loch-Breath Sip	3 silver	Breathe under calm water for one scene.
Giant-Step Tonic	1 gold	+1 Strength for lifting, pushing, or carrying in one scene.
Foxwit Tea	1 gold	+1 Int for riddles, traps, or runes in one scene.

Poisons and venoms

Poisons in this game are scary obstacles, not lethal gore. They make adventurers sleepy, confused, glittered, or slowed until treated.

Poison	Source	Effect / cure
Nightshade Jam	Redcap trick	Sleepy for one scene; cured by bitter tea.
Black Bog Venom	Bog drake bite or thorn	-1 Agility until washed with clean running water.
Iron Crow Ink	Cursed feather	Cannot speak a lie; cured by confessing one useful truth.
Frost-Thistle Prickle	Winter barb	Startled; cured by warm cloak and a brave song.

